

Messiaen was equally radical in his approach to tempo. He sometimes lengthened individual notes or played them very slowly (occasionally, he marked the tempo as "infinitely slow"). *Le Banquet céleste*, for example, consists of only 25 bars, but when Messiaen performed it, the piece could last for seven or eight minutes. This helped to endow it with a solemn, meditative quality.



MARCEL DUPRÉ

An atmospheric depiction by Ambrose McEvoy of organist Marcel Dupré at the organ of Notre-Dame, Paris. Dupré was an